TRUSTMRR SESSION 3 · 1,000-COMPANY CENSUS

Inside 1,000 Startups

What 1,000 verified, revenue-connected startups reveal about where money actually concentrates — and where it doesn't.

Prepared for the CEO · Data frozen 30 July 2026 · Source: TrustMRR.com

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Four numbers that define this market

Across 1,000 startups with verified, API-connected revenue, the headline is concentration: a small elite captures almost everything, while the crowded middle earns very little — and the most-hyped category is not the best-paying one.

48%

of all recurring revenue in the network is earned by just the top 1% of companies (10 of 1,000).

$282 vs $13,472

median monthly revenue per company vs. the mean — a 47x gap that shows how misleading "average" is here.

27% → 13%

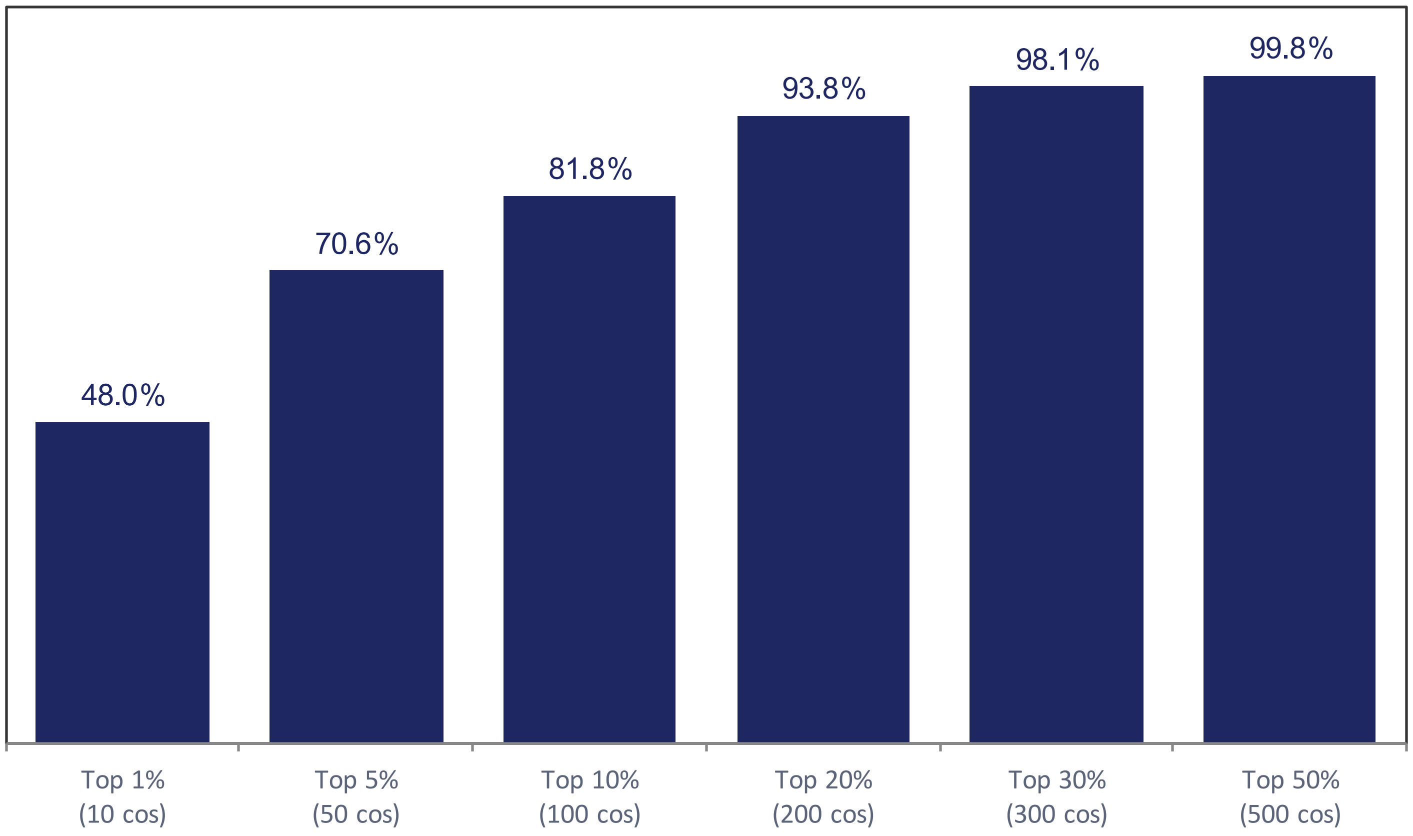
AI is the single most crowded category (27% of companies) but captures only 13% of category revenue.

262 · $86.8M

companies are actively for sale, worth a combined $86.8M in asking price at a 2.3x median multiple.

Revenue follows a hard power law

Cumulative share of network MRR, by top-earner percentile



$13.47M

total monthly recurring revenue tracked across all 1,000 startups.

$334M

combined all-time revenue processed by the cohort since founding.

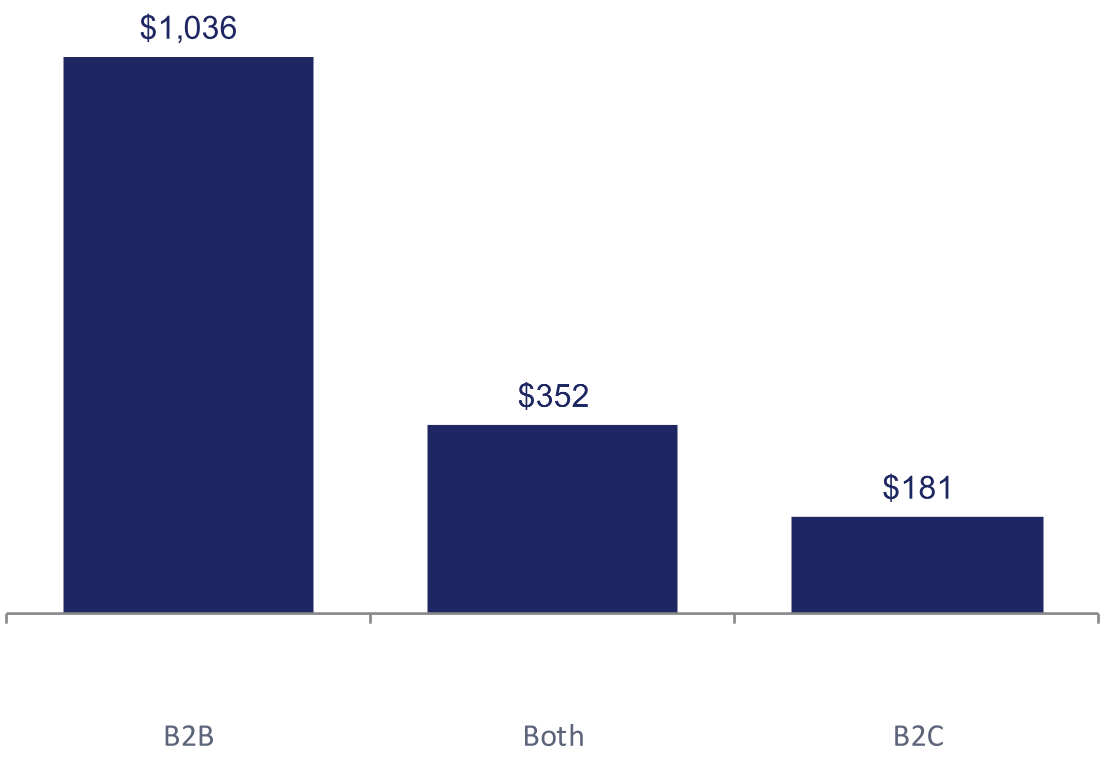
47x gap

between the median company ($282/mo) and the mean ($13,472/mo).

SEGMENT ECONOMICS

B2B customers are worth roughly 5x more

Median company MRR, by audience type



REVENUE PER ACTIVE SUBSCRIBER (ARPU)

$49 / mo

median B2B revenue per active subscription.

$9.34 / mo

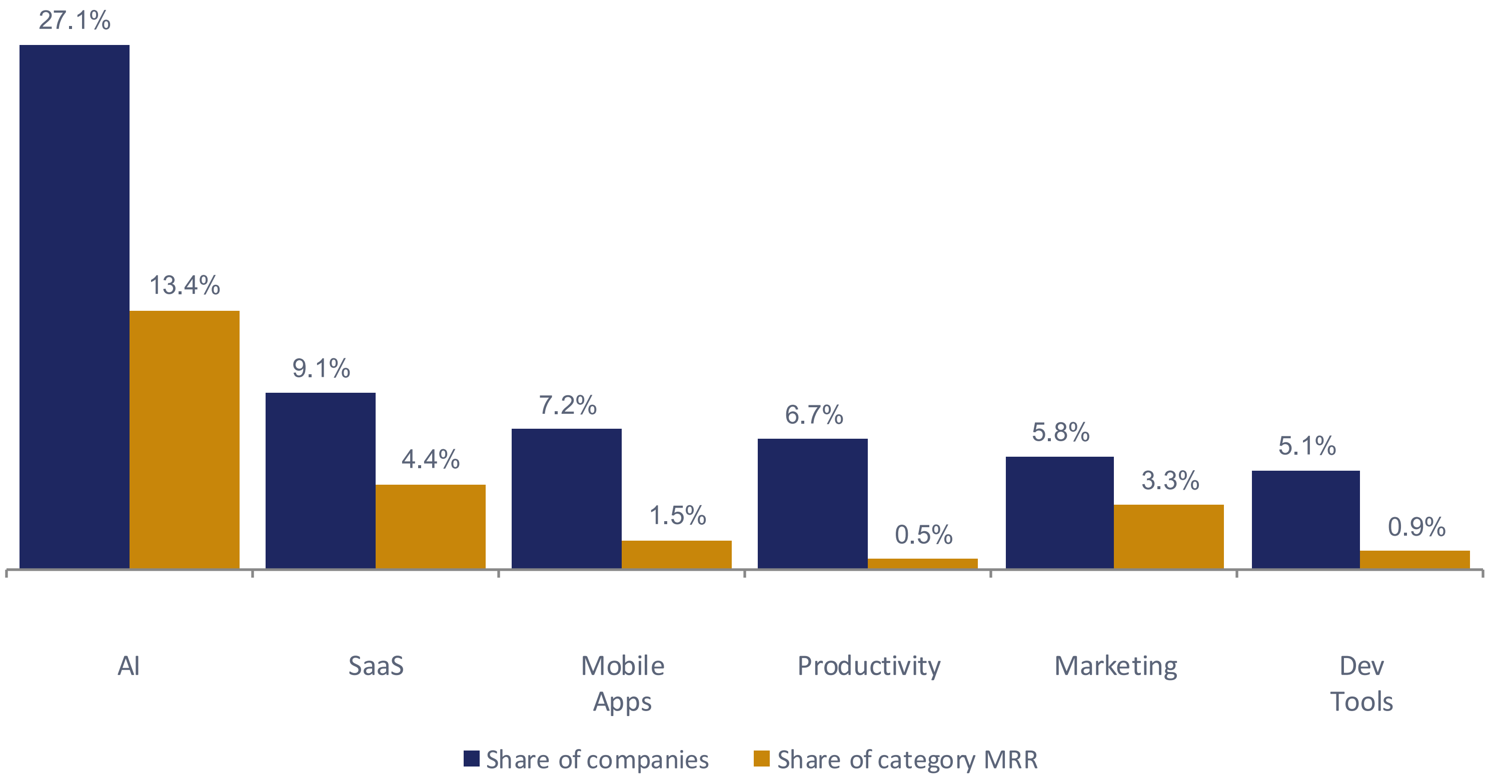
median B2C revenue per active subscription — about 1/5th of B2B.

255 B2B companies out-earn 401 B2C companies in aggregate MRR ($3.35M vs $2.05M) despite being 36% fewer in number.

CATEGORY REALITY CHECK

The busiest category isn't the best-paying one

Among the 726 categorized startups: share of headcount vs. share of MRR



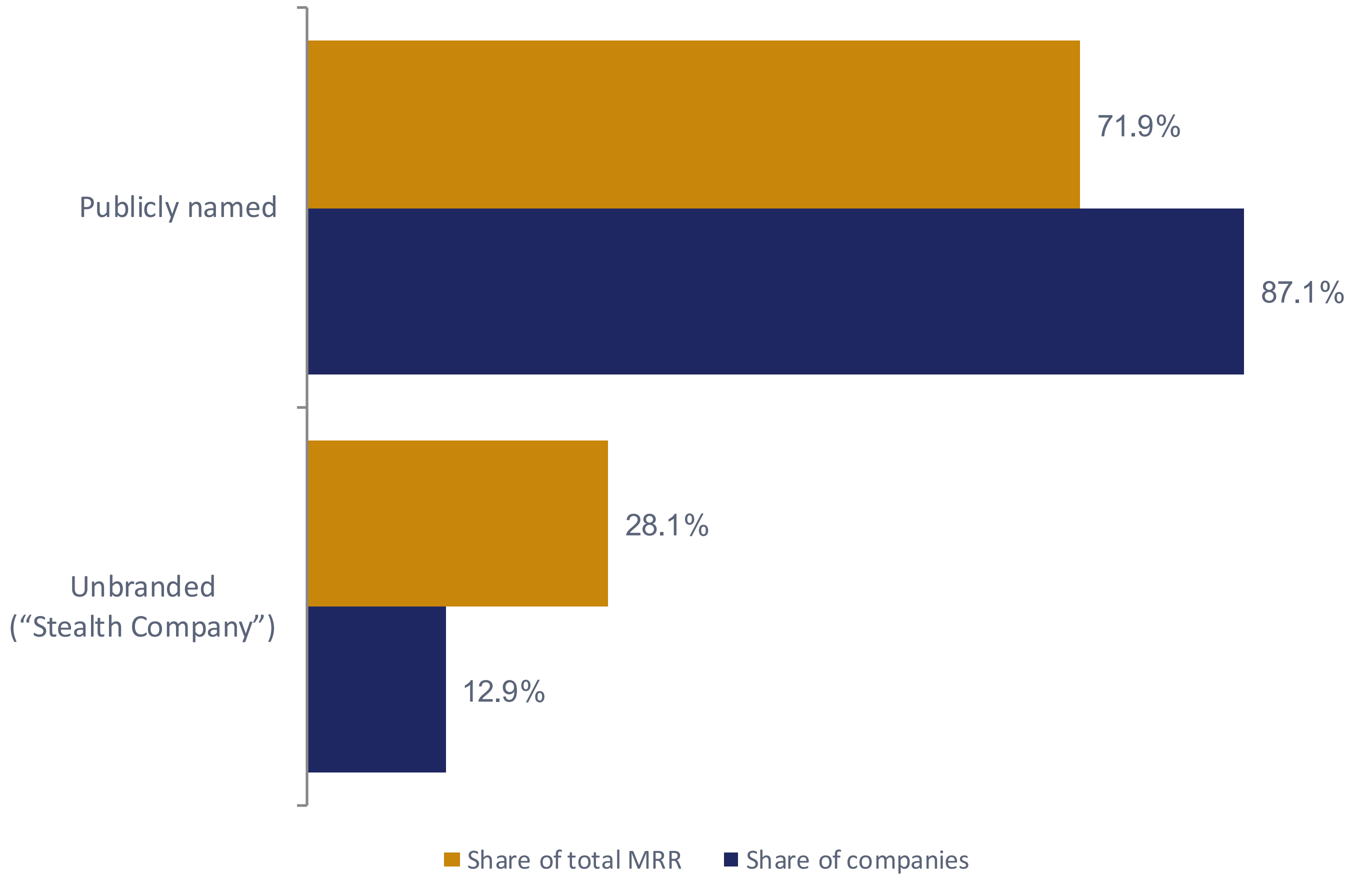
$2,141

median MRR for Education startups (30 companies) — the strongest unit economics of any category with 10+ entrants.

$446

median MRR for AI startups (197 companies, the largest single category) — near the bottom of the pack.

The biggest earners are often the least visible



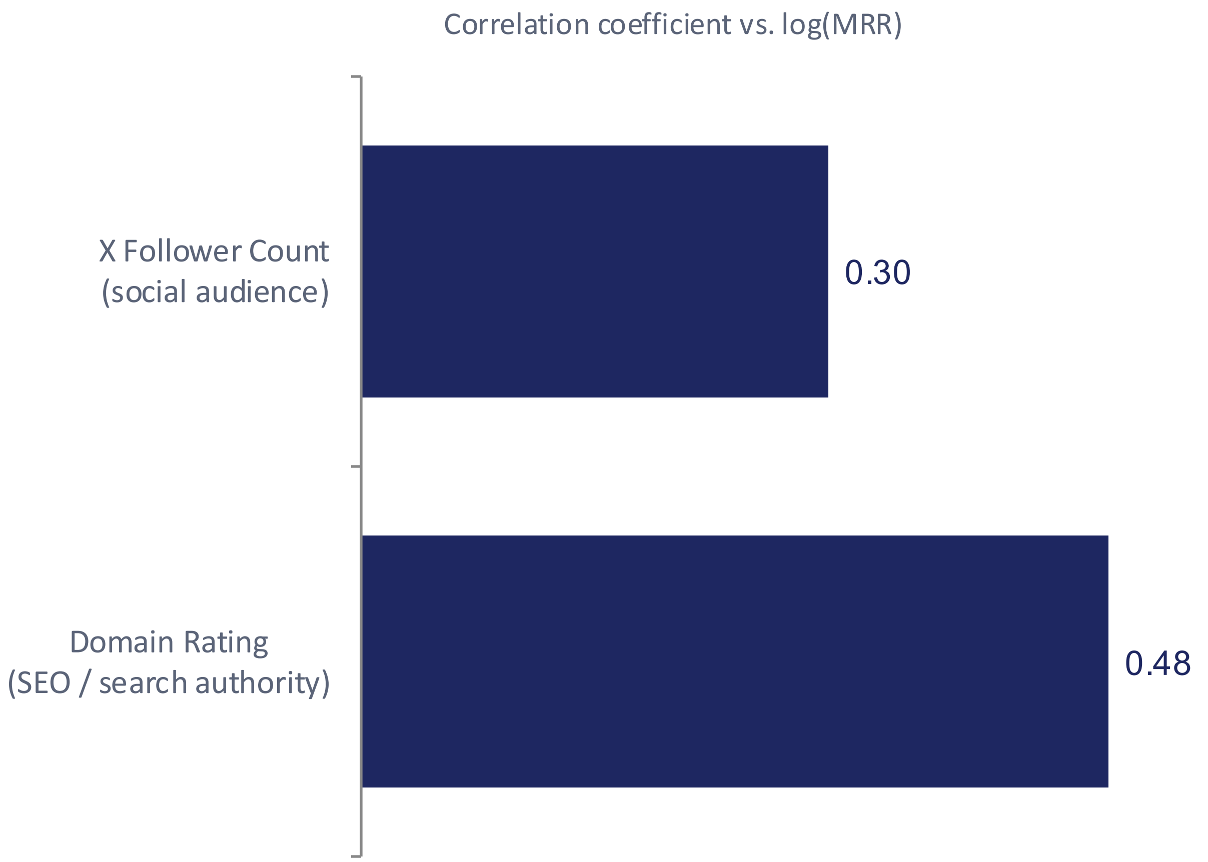
129

companies list only as “Stealth Company” — 12.9% of the dataset, with no public brand disclosed.

2.2x

over-representation in revenue: stealth operators earn 28.1% of network MRR from just 12.9% of the headcount.

Search authority beats social following



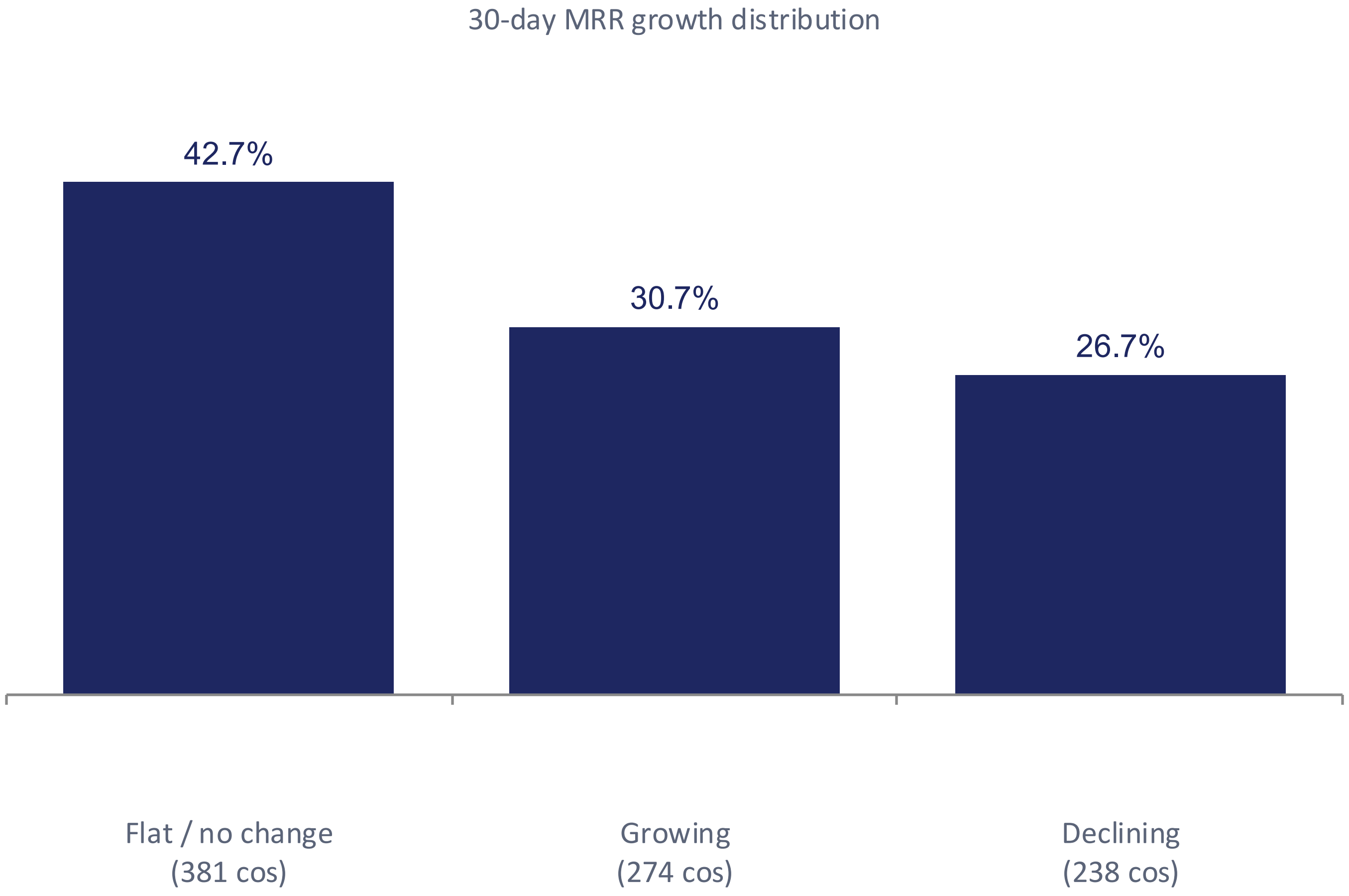
1.6x

stronger relationship between domain authority and revenue than between follower count and revenue.

30.7%

of companies show zero X followers on record, yet still generate active revenue.

30-day growth is noisy until revenue has scale



0%

median 30-day MRR growth across the entire network.

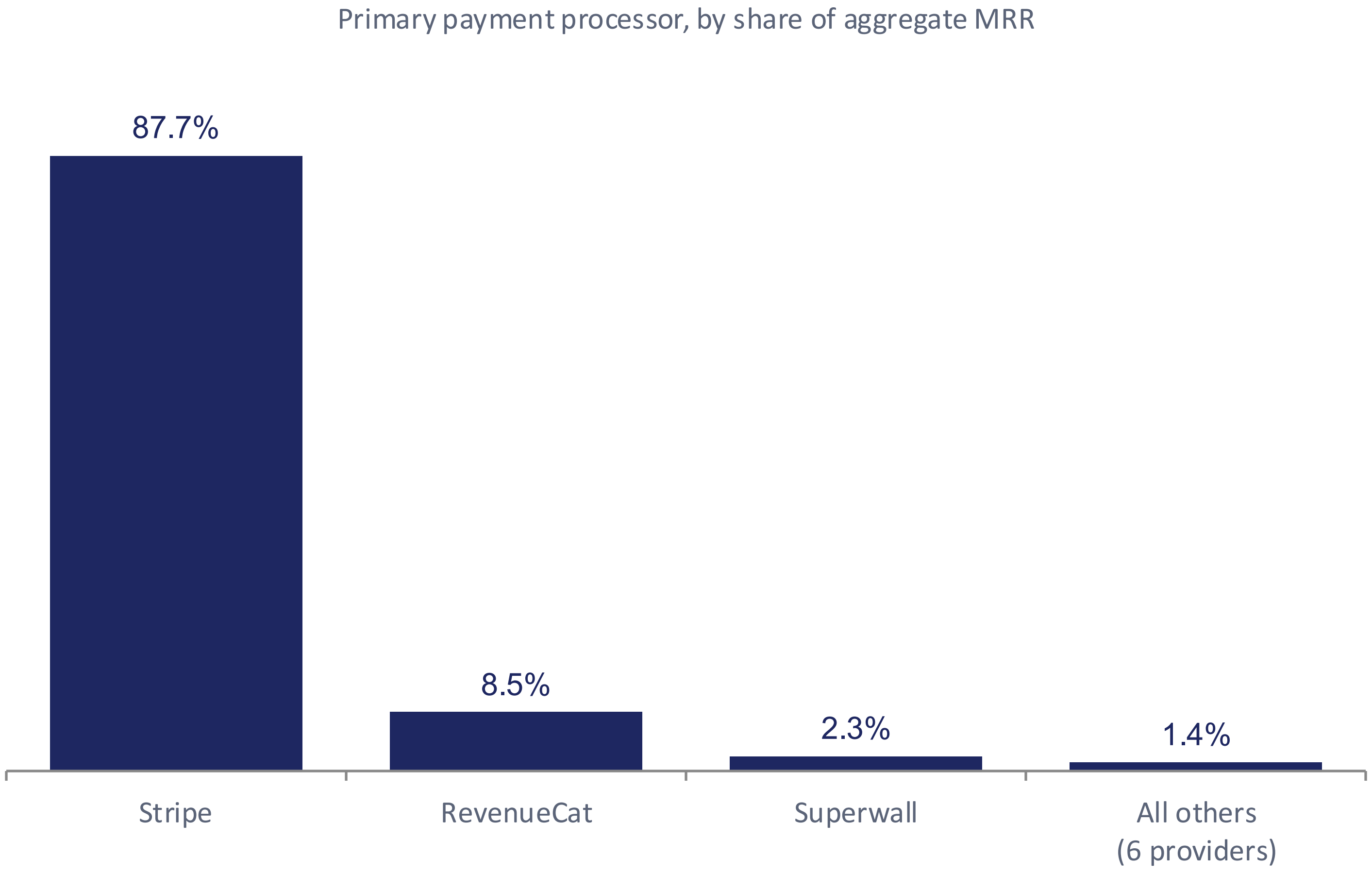
+33%

mean growth — pulled far above the median by a handful of extreme, small-base outliers.

+12,983%

the single largest 30-day swing in the dataset, on a base of just $135,899 MRR — a reminder that % growth is unreliable before revenue reaches scale.

Stripe processes almost every dollar that matters



64.4%

of companies run Stripe as their primary payment rail — the default for indie SaaS.

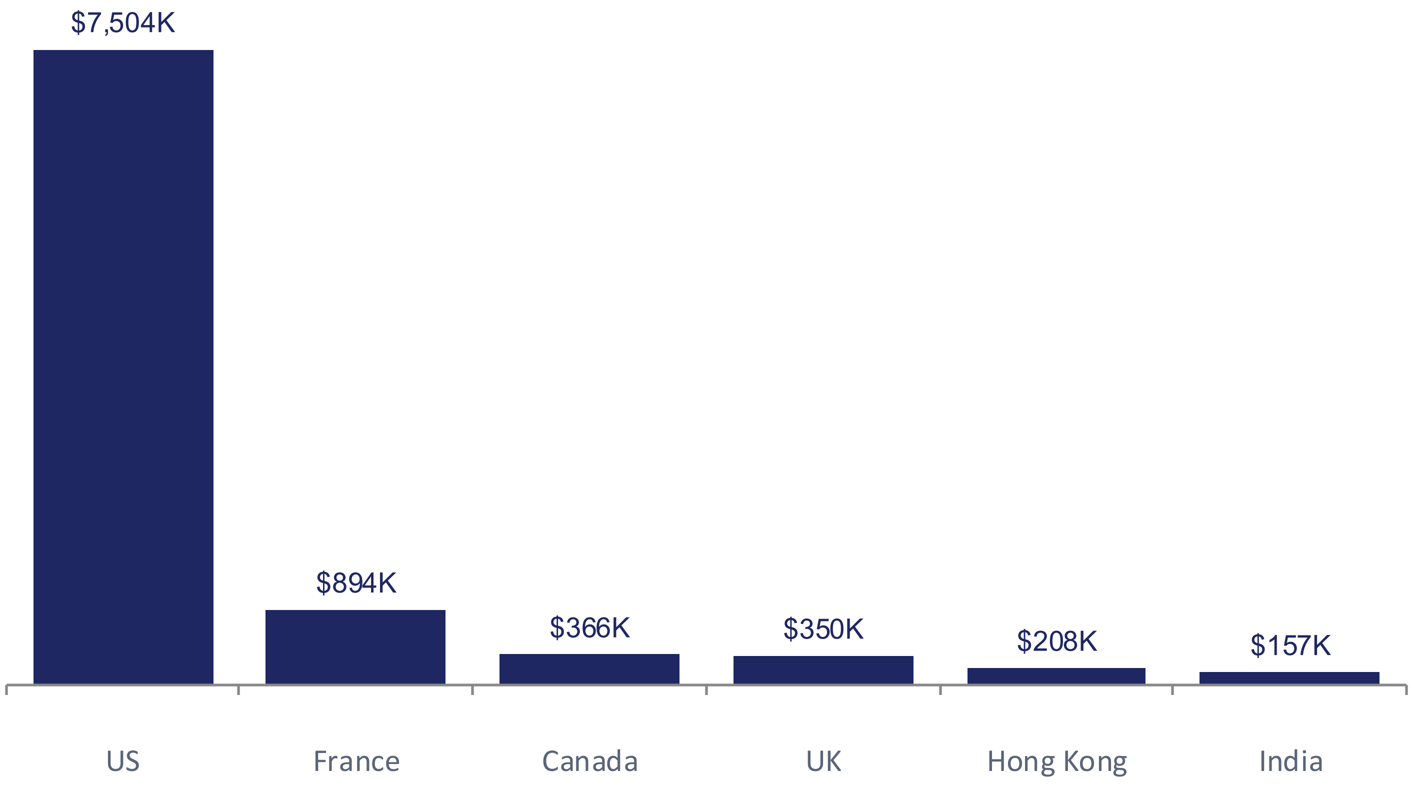
RevenueCat #2

the clear leader for mobile subscription billing, concentrated among B2C app companies.

GEOGRAPHY

The US builds fewer, but far bigger, companies

Total MRR by headquarters country (top 6)



34% → 56%

the US is 34% of companies with a disclosed HQ, but captures 56% of total network MRR.

24.1%

of companies disclose no country at all — treat geographic totals as directional, not exhaustive.

One in four tracked companies is for sale

262

companies (26.2% of the dataset) are actively listed for sale on the platform.

$86.8M

combined asking price across all 261 listings with a disclosed price.

15.2%

share of total network MRR represented by companies currently on the market.

2.3x

median asking revenue multiple across all for-sale listings (10th–90th pct: 0x–10.4x).

SO WHAT

Five implications for anyone entering this market

1. **Don’t benchmark against the average.**

   With a 47x gap between median and mean MRR, use the median ($282) and category-specific percentiles — not network averages — to judge a company's standing.

2. **Treat “AI” as a crowded lane, not a strategy.**

   It's the single largest category by headcount but converts headcount to revenue worse than smaller categories like Education. Differentiation inside AI matters more than being in AI.

3. **Weight SEO and search authority over social proof.**

   Domain rating tracks revenue more tightly than X followers — and 31% of profitable companies have no social following at all.

4. **Ignore 30-day growth % on small-revenue companies.**

   Below a meaningful MRR base, growth rates swing by thousands of percent on noise. Look at absolute dollar trajectory instead.

5. **The exit market is real and liquidly priced.**

   262 companies are for sale today at a median 2.3x revenue multiple — a live comparable set for acquisition or divestment decisions.